

life and the results were pretty solid; not as path-breaking as the class-leading iQOO Neo 7 Pro, but solid nonetheless. I was able to run Call of Duty: Mobile at high graphics and frame rate with minimal stutter and lag. The phone also did a good job keeping the temps in check.

In day-to-day tasks, the phone rose to the occasion with impressive multitasking abilities and solid overall performance with very few hiccups. So, even though it may not break records in benchmarking tests, this is still a fast and reliable phone that will appease most users.

It is not the performance but the UI that takes points away from the performance department. The Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G comes with MIUI 14 based on Android 13 out of the box – so, you will not get HyperOS out of the box and you will also be greeted with a TON of bloatware preinstalled on your phone. This includes random apps such as PhonePe, Netflix, Snapchat, LinkedIn, YT Music, and nine preinstalled games. There are also a bunch of Xiaomi apps pre-bundled with the phone. Software support has improved though, with 3 years of promised OS updates and 4 years of security updates.

CAMERA

The Redmi Note 13 Pro+ boasts an all-new triple camera setup comprising of a 200 MP Samsung ISOCELL HP3 camera with OIS and EIS capabilities, an 8 MP ultrawide shooter, and a 2 MP macro camera. This sensor is capable of pulling in quite a bit of detail in ideal lighting conditions, but in my experience, it did struggle to some extent in low light.

The main camera captures crisp and detailed shots with decent colour. The dynamic range is a bit of a hit-and-miss in some situations, but in most instances, you get a solid, social-media-worthy shot. Natural bokeh is strong because of the size of the lens and the camera also focuses on subjects pretty easily in good lighting conditions.

Portrait mode images look vibrant and the edge detection is impressive,

but there is some softness present. The 8 MP ultrawide lens does a good job of clicking detailed images in daylight with minimal softness around the edges. The 2 MP macro camera is a disappointment though, with blurry and shaky shots. The 16 MP selfie camera is decent but nothing to write home about – you can expect good shots in daylight, and soft images in low light.

In low light, I saw a considerable amount of noise creep into the pictures, and the dynamic range took a hit as well, especially in the shadow areas. As for video, it is disappointing since



the rear camera only supports 4K video at a maximum of 30 fps and the front camera doesn't support 4K at all. The stabilisation of the rear camera video has improved compared to the previous generation though.

BATTERY LIFE

Housing a 5,000 mAh battery, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G powers through a day's worth of usage with relative ease. The battery life is as good as its competitors, although it is not path-breaking. I got through a day of gaming, benchmarking, clicking photos, and browsing the web with 10 per cent battery remaining at 9 PM. In our 4K video loop test, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ lasted a decent 13 hours and 9 minutes.

The phone does support super fast 120 W charging though which obliterates the charging speed of most of its competitors. You can charge this phone from an empty battery to full in just over 20 minutes (you need to turn on

maximum charging speed in settings first), which is extremely impressive. The phone does get quite hot during this process though.

VERDICT

The Redmi Note 13 Pro+ 5G is a massive upgrade over its predecessor in most areas – it gets a new premium design, an IP68 rating, almost double the screen brightness, a faster processor, an improved camera, an in-display fingerprint sensor, and more. These upgrades also make it stand tall amidst competition but there's one area where it falls behind – performance.

The likes of the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and OnePlus Nord 3 blow past the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ in synthetic benchmarks and real-world gaming.

Furthermore, the phone doesn't come with HyperOS and Android 14 out of the box – something that the upcoming POCO X6 Pro is getting.

The phone is rife with

bloatware which takes away from its premium factor. If you can look past the bloatware, the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ is undeniably a well-rounded phone; it's not going to win any raw performance awards – but it will be popular given the slew of features and specifications it offers for sure.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 7200 Ultra | RAM: 8 / 12 GB LPDDR5 | ROM: 256 / 512 GB UFS 3.1 | ISP: Imagiq 765 | Cooling System: 4000mm² VC | Display: 6.67-inch AMOLED, 1.5 K resolution, 120 Hz refresh rate | Display protection: Gorilla Glass Victus | Camera: 200 MP ISOCELL HP3 (OIS) + 8 MP ultrawide + 2 MP macro | Video (rear camera): Up to 4K at 30 fps | Front camera: 16 MP, video up to 1080p at 60 fps | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging 120 W HyperCharge (19 minutes from 0-100%) | IP rating: IP68 | UI: MIUI 14 based on Android 13 | Weight: 204.5 g

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